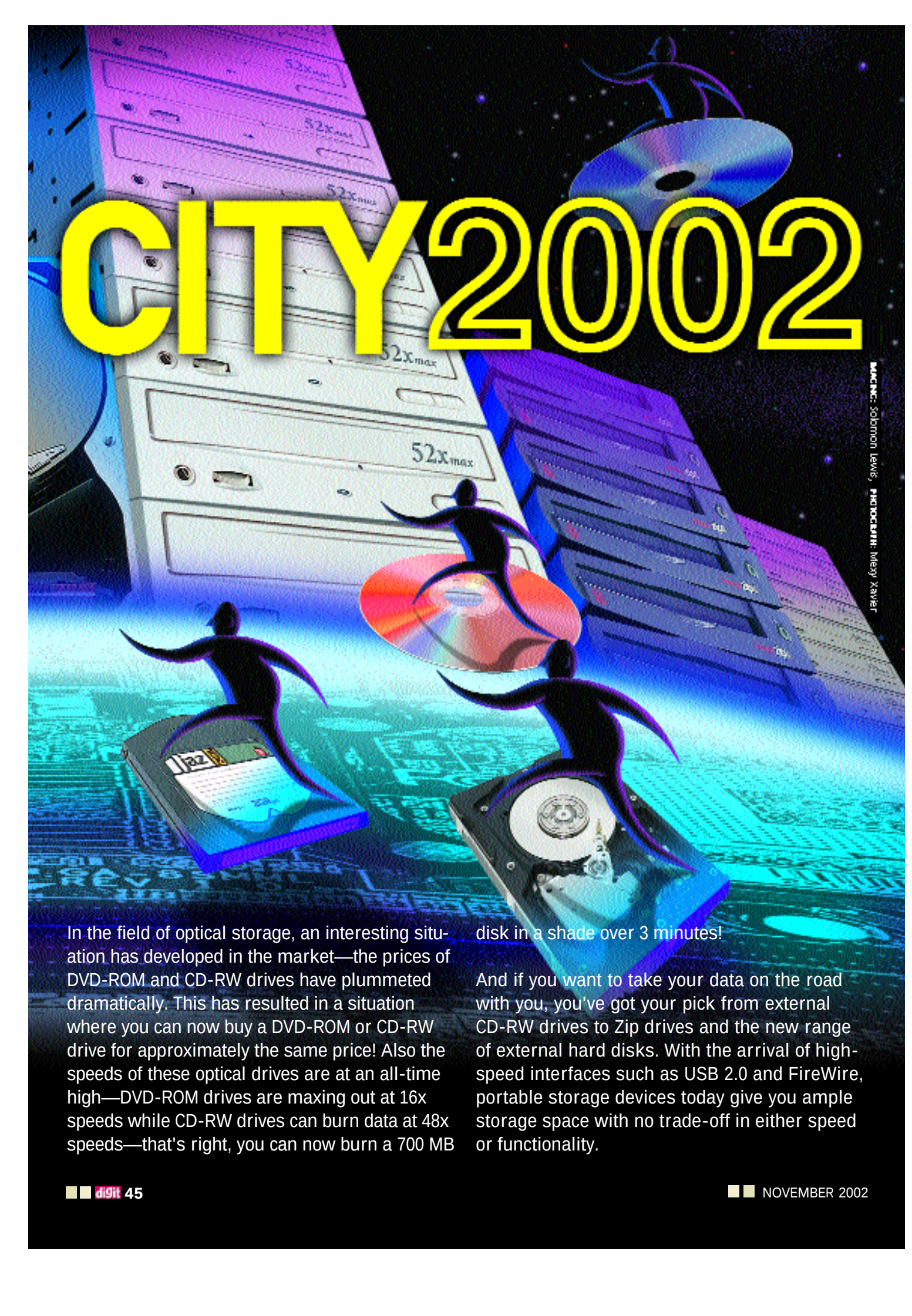




CITY 2002

IMAGING: Solomon Lewis, PHOTOGRAPH: Micky Xavier

In the field of optical storage, an interesting situation has developed in the market—the prices of DVD-ROM and CD-RW drives have plummeted dramatically. This has resulted in a situation where you can now buy a DVD-ROM or CD-RW drive for approximately the same price! Also the speeds of these optical drives are at an all-time high—DVD-ROM drives are maxing out at 16x speeds while CD-RW drives can burn data at 48x speeds—that's right, you can now burn a 700 MB

disk in a shade over 3 minutes!

And if you want to take your data on the road with you, you've got your pick from external CD-RW drives to Zip drives and the new range of external hard disks. With the arrival of high-speed interfaces such as USB 2.0 and FireWire, portable storage devices today give you ample storage space with no trade-off in either speed or functionality.